

Parasha Eikev – Remaining Humble Amidst Assured Blessings Deuteronomy 7:12-11:25

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“Speak not thou in thy heart, after that the LORD thy God hath thrust them out from before thee, saying: ‘For my righteousness the LORD hath brought me in to possess this land’; whereas for the wickedness of these nations the LORD doth drive them out from before thee.”

Parasha Eikev offers many important life lessons, one of which will be the focus here – **humility in times of plenty**. In the Parasha, we learn that as was promise to our forefathers Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, the realization of blessings to *Am Yisrael* is sure. As a community and country, we experience the broader struggle together as we reach the threshold of realizing communal blessings. Yet, it is the individual and family stories that weave together the tapestry of our shared experience. These personal narratives are crucial, especially during times of trial. As we gradually move into the phase of receiving these promised blessings, which even grows throughout the years as fruits of the “word of *HaShem*”, we must remain mindful of their true source.

Eikev teaches us not to be subsumed in the blessings we will receive, nor to forget the simple things that matter the most – the profound knowledge found in the Torah. Lest we lose sight of life’s true blessings and its benefits – being provided with liberty and the knowledge that true living comes from *living by the very word of the Torah, the very word of God in all we do – this is the true source of all blessings and must become our satisfaction*.

No matter how plentiful or abundant the material blessings may be when they come, they must always be secondary and serve to advance the growth and *justice* of God’s word on earth – *the template of Avinu Abraham*. To ensure we do not lose sight of this fact Deuteronomy 9:4-5, reads:

“Speak not thou in thy heart, after that the LORD thy God hath thrust them out from before thee, saying: ‘For my righteousness the LORD hath brought me in to possess this land’; whereas for the wickedness of these nations the LORD doth drive them out from before thee. Not for thy righteousness, or for the uprightness of thy heart, dost thou go in to possess their land; but for the wickedness of these nations the LORD thy God doth drive them out from before thee, and that He may establish the word which the LORD swore unto thy fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.”

So, as we enjoy the secondary fruits of the Torah, let’s always be conscious of remaining grounded in humility. Even if humility does not come naturally to us, we should cultivate it through logical reflection, recognizing that God bestows these blessings out of His own will and mission, as promised to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. As without the Light of the Torah and its directions, the words of **יִשְׁעִיָּהוּ** HaNavi, become evident:

*“Ah, Those who call evil good And good evil; Who present darkness as light
And light as darkness; Who present bitter as sweet And sweet as bitter!” Isaiah 5:20*